Document 30: Student Clubs, Cultural Fests & Event Sponsorship Guidelines

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1. Club Formation, Charter Renewal, and Faculty Advisors

Student clubs form the backbone of extracurricular life at the Hyderabad Institute of Technology (HIT). However, to prevent the creation of inactive or duplicate groups, the administration heavily regulates how a club is born and how it maintains its official status.

To propose a new club, the organizing students must submit a formal "Charter Application" to the Dean of Student Affairs. This application must contain the digital signatures of at least 30 enrolled students who pledge to be active members. Furthermore, every single club must have a dedicated Faculty Advisor. The students organize the events, but the Faculty Advisor takes legal and administrative responsibility for the club. The Faculty Advisor must digitally sign every event request, budget proposal, and travel document.

The Charter Renewal and Advisor Resignation Rule: Clubs do not last forever automatically. Every club must renew its charter annually by August 15th. If a club's active membership falls below 20 students during the renewal check, the club is placed on a "Six-Month Probation." If the designated Faculty Advisor decides to resign from their role (due to workload or leaving the university), the club's official status is instantly frozen. The student leaders have exactly 14 calendar days to find a new teacher to replace them. During this 14-day freeze, the club is completely banned from hosting meetings, sending campus-wide emails, or spending any university money. If they fail to find a new advisor by the deadline, the club is permanently dissolved.

2. Institutional Funding Tiers and GST Receipt Rules

The university distributes funds to student clubs based on a strict two-tier classification system. A club's tier determines its maximum allowed budget for the academic year.

- **Tier A Clubs (Legacy & Major Impact):** A club is classified as Tier A only if it has been continuously active for more than three years and hosts a minimum of one campus-wide festival per year (for example, the annual Robotics Fest or the main Cultural Dance Fest). Tier A clubs are eligible for an institutional grant of up to ₹1,00,000 per academic year.
- **Tier B Clubs (New & Special Interest):** Any club younger than three years, or clubs that only host small internal workshops (like a niche Data Science study group or a chess club), are classified as Tier B. These clubs are capped at a maximum institutional grant of ₹25,000 per academic year.

The Strict Reimbursement and Receipt Law: The university does not give clubs cash in advance. Students must spend their own money first and then claim a reimbursement. To get their money back, the student must submit a computerized, printed receipt that clearly shows a valid 15-digit GSTIN (Goods and Services Tax Identification Number). Handwritten paper bills, unverified cash memos, or receipts without a GSTIN will result in exactly 0% reimbursement. The only exception to the GST rule is for local auto-rickshaw transport used for club errands; students can claim a maximum of ₹500 per event for auto-rickshaws by submitting a signed "Petty Cash Transport Voucher."

3. Corporate Sponsorships and the Prohibited Branding Blacklist

Because the university grants are often not enough to host a massive yearly fest, clubs are permitted to seek outside corporate sponsorships. However, students must be extremely careful about who they accept money from, as they are representing the HIT brand.

The university maintains a strict "Blacklist" of industries. Clubs are absolutely banned from accepting money, free products, or promotional materials from companies involved in:

1. Alcohol, liquor, or breweries (including "zero-alcohol" surrogate advertising).
2. Tobacco, cigarettes, e-cigarettes, and vaping products.
3. Real-money online gaming, betting, or gambling apps.
4. Cryptocurrency exchanges or unregulated financial trading platforms.

The Cancellation Penalty: Before printing any banners or posters, the club must submit all sponsor logos to the Dean of Student Affairs for clearance. If a club bypasses this rule and displays a blacklisted company's logo anywhere on campus (even on a small digital flyer), the consequences are severe. The university will immediately cancel the entire festival, force the crowd to disperse, and levy a massive ₹15,000 punitive fine directly on the core committee students. The club will also be downgraded to Tier B for the next two academic years.

4. Noise Ordinances and the 10:00 PM Hard Stop

Yearly cultural fests often involve large speaker systems and live music. Because the campus also contains residential hostels and a central library where students are studying, the university strictly controls noise levels and event timings.

Outdoor events with amplified sound (heavy bass speakers, microphones, or live drums) are only permitted between 5:00 PM and 10:00 PM on Fridays, Saturdays, and Sundays. The sound volume must never exceed 85 decibels at a distance of 50 meters from the stage.

The Escalating Time Fine: The 10:00 PM curfew is a hard, non-negotiable stop. All music, stage lights, and microphones must be completely powered off at exactly 22:00 hours. If a club fails to stop the music, the university security team will apply an escalating financial penalty:

- If the music is still playing at 10:01 PM, the club is hit with an instant base fine of ₹1,000.
- For every single additional minute the music continues past 10:01 PM, an extra ₹500 is added to the fine.
- *Example:* If the club finally turns off the speakers at 10:06 PM, they will pay the ₹1,000 base fine (for 10:01) plus ₹2,500 for the extra five minutes (10:02 to 10:06), resulting in a total fine of ₹3,500. This fine is deducted directly from the club's institutional budget.

5. Celebrity Guest Performers and Damage Liabilities

When a club decides to invite a famous external performer—such as a celebrity singer, a popular music band, or a high-profile DJ—for the main concert night, the risk of crowd control issues and property damage increases massively.

If a club expects a crowd of more than 500 people, or if they are hosting a paid external artist, they must pay a "Security and Damage Deposit" of ₹50,000 to the university accounts office exactly 7 days before the performer arrives on campus. The event will not be approved if this deposit is not paid.

The Liability Deduction Protocol: After the concert finishes, the campus facilities team will inspect the auditorium or the open-air theater the following morning.

- If the crowd damaged university property during the excitement of the concert, the repair costs are taken directly out of the ₹50,000 deposit. For example, a broken plastic chair is billed at ₹800, and a damaged stage barricade is billed at ₹3,000.
- If the total damage is less than the deposit, the remaining balance is refunded to the club within 14 days.
- However, if the crowd causes a massive riot and the damages exceed the ₹50,000 deposit (e.g., breaking expensive stage lights or smashing glass doors), the student organizers on the core committee are held personally responsible. The extra repair costs will be added to the students' personal tuition fee accounts, and they will not be allowed to write their final semester exams until the debt is cleared.